

Question 42 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Describe the major steps involved in designing a training program.

Introduction

Design is Stage 2 of the training cycle (planning the training). A training plan describes key decisions, tasks and resources. Design converts TNA into a blueprint. If TNA is skipped, these steps decorate the wrong building.

Detailed points

- 1. Confirm needs, trainees and readiness.** Re-check TNA; ensure learners have basic skills and motivation (readiness). Unready trainees fail even good design.
- 2. Set goals and learning objectives.** Overall capability to be achieved, and specific observable objectives ('be able to do...'). Objectives drive everything else.
- 3. Select content and sequence.** What topics, in what order, theory then practice. Content must match tasks from TNA, not the trainer's favourite stories.
- 4. Choose methods and activities.** Lectures, workshops, cases, role play, OJT, e-learning, team sessions — matched to objectives (skill needs practice).
- 5. Decide location and provider.** On-the-job or off-the-job? Internal or outsourced? Inside company or off-site? These are listed in the notes as planning issues.
- 6. Plan facilities, trainers, materials, budget.** Venue, AV, handouts, meals, resource persons, costs that accounts will accept. Poor admin later looks like poor training.
- 7. Design transfer of training.** Pre-brief bosses, action plans, post-training projects, job aids. Transfer is designed, not hoped.
- 8. Build evaluation into the plan.** Reaction sheets, learning tests, behaviour follow-up, result measures agreed now. Evaluation is not an afterthought.

Conclusion. List steps in order from TNA confirmation to evaluation design. Mention the planning matrix: goal, objectives, methods, facilities, budget. Design is a plan for learning, not a timetable of speeches.